Foods like fruits, vegetables and nuts are eaten raw but most of the foods are cooked to bring about desirable changes. The process of subjecting foods to the action of heat is termed as "**Cooking**". Heat is transferred to food during cooking by conduction, convection, radiation or microwave energy. Cooking takes place by moist and dry heat. Moist heat involves water and steam. Air or fat is used in dry heat.

Cooking can be defined as the transfer of energy from one source to another. This energy alter the foods molecular structure, changing its texture, flavour, aroma and appearance and thus making it safe to consume.

1.7.1 Objectives of cooking

- Improves the taste and food quality
- Destruction of micro-organisms
- Improves digestibility
- Increases variety
- Increases availability of nutrients
- Increases antioxidant value
- Concentrates nutrients
- Removes pesticide residues
- Removes natural toxins

1.7.2 Classification of Cooking Methods

The methods of cooking are classified as given in **table 1.1**

1.7.2 a Moist Heat Method

In this method, food comes in contact with moisture either by water or steam under pressure. Some common ways of cooking food by moist heat are described below.

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Water soluble nutrients present in food dissolve in water in which the food is boiled. If you throw this water, nutrients will be lost. Suggest some useful ways for the utilisation of the stock.

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Table 1.1 Methods of Cooking

Moist Heat Method	Dry Heat Method	Combination Method
Boiling	Roasting	Braising
Stewing	Grilling	
Steaming	Toasting	
Pressure Cooking	Baking	
Poaching	Sauteing	
Blanching	Frying	

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